



It might look like the outline of a big city, but these blocks are cubes of fluorite. Fluorite comes in many colours. It can even be more than one colour within the same crystal and, if you shine a special ultraviolet light on it, it changes colour to bright blue and seems to glow! This glowing is called fluorescence (floor-ess-ense).

One special variety of fluorite is Blue John. This type of fluorite has beautiful bands of purple, white, and yellow, and it is mined in Derbyshire, UK. The Ancient Romans used Blue John to make cups and other decorative items, and it is still collected today.



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